generally and, in a sense, paying formal obeisance to them, do

not consider them as infallible, and indeed go their own way without

much regard for them. As the Vedas and the Upanishads spoke

educational authorities of newly founded republic of Burials in Transbaikalia in the U.S.S.R.

started an anti-religious propaganda, they emphasized that modern science takes a materia-

listic view of the universe. The Buddhist monks of that republic, who were Mahayanists,

retorted in a pamphlet, pointing out that materialism was not unknown to them and that,

in fact, one of their schools had developed a materialistic theory.

** Professor Stcherbatsky who is an authority on the subject, having personally examined the original texts in various languages, including Tibetan, says that 'shunyata' is relativity.*

Everything being relative and interdependent has no absoluteness by itself. Hence it is 'shunya.'

On the other hand, there is something entirely beyond the phenomenal world, but comprising

it, which might be considered the absolute. This cannot be conceived or described in terms

of the finite and phenomenal world and hence it is referred to as 'tathata' or thatness, suchness.

This absolute has also been called 'shunyata'.